



So Sach

Snap the receipt. The books do themselves.

AI bookkeeper on Zalo — Vietnam's 5.2M household businesses



Business Plan

July 2026 · Pre-seed

01

Executive Summary

Vietnam has manufactured a once-in-a-decade compliance shock: from 1 January 2026 the lump-sum (khoán) tax regime is abolished and ~5.2 million household businesses (hộ kinh doanh) must keep books and self-declare — first quarterly filing due 30 April 2026. Since June 2025, businesses above 1B VND revenue must also issue e-invoices from tax-connected cash registers (Decree 70/2025, now carried in Decree 254/2026, in force since 01/07/2026). Incumbent software (MISA, KiotViet, Sapo) records transactions; nobody explains and files in the language of a street vendor. Sổ Sạch does: photograph a receipt in Zalo — Vietnam's default app with ~80M monthly users — and the AI writes the ledger, watches the tax thresholds and pre-fills the quarterly declaration (form 01/CNKD).

- Product LIVE today at so-sach.onrender.com: photo→ledger→thresholds→declaration, Zalo OA bot ready (env-gated), Vietnamese-first UI.
- Model: 69,000 VND/month (~\$2.7) consumer-simple SaaS + 30% reseller share to tax agents; COGS pennies per user (Haiku vision) → >85% gross margin.
- Founder edge: licensed Vietnamese company (SaaS sales) already operating; e-invoice issuance is a first-party obligation we live ourselves.
- Ask: \$300k pre-seed for 18 months: 12,000 subscribers and the tax-agent reseller network.

02

The Problem

- A forced march, not a choice. Millions of micro-businesses that never kept a ledger must now produce quarterly declarations. State media reports persistent confusion; the tax authority itself urged simpler software.
- The tools speak accountant, not vendor. MISA/KiotViet/Sapo assume double-entry literacy, desktop workflows and 160–600k VND price points designed for shops with staff.
- The trusted channel is a cousin with a calculator. Tax agents (đại lý thuế) are drowning in new mandates — they need leverage, not competition.

03

The Solution

- Zalo-native. No new app, no password: follow the OA, send a photo. The bot replies with the recorded entry; 'sổ' returns the running summary.
- Threshold radar. Live bars toward the 500M taxable threshold and the 1B e-invoice mandate, with plain-language alerts before crossing.
- Declaration, pre-filled. Form 01/CNKD (Circular 40/2021) with the correct presumptive rates per business category, exemption logic, and a print/PDF view a tax agent can file.
- Built to rent the moat. E-invoice transmission stays with GDT-accredited providers — we integrate one (MISA/Viettel/VNPT) and sell the intelligence layer above.

04

Market

	Value	Notes
TAM	5.2M	household businesses forced into bookkeeping from 2026
SAM	~1.8M	smartphone-active hộ with 200M–3B VND revenue (bookkeeping duty)
SOM (Y3)	40k subs	~2.2% of SAM via HCMC → southern provinces

Context: Vietnam's digital economy reached ~\$39B GMV in 2025; QR payments are ubiquitous down to street stalls (street-vendor QR usage +85% YoY). The rails exist — the back office doesn't.

05

Business Model

Stream	Mechanics	Y3 share
Core subscription	69k VND/mo — photo ledger, thresholds, declaration draft	62%
Pro 149k	multi-location, exports, e-invoice issuance via partner API	23%
Tax-agent tier	agent dashboard for 20–200 clients; 30% rev-share to the agent	15%

Unit economics: COGS ≈ \$0.2–0.4/user/month (Haiku vision on ~150 receipts). Payments via MoMo/ZaloPay/VietQR from the Vietnamese entity — no western MoR needed.

06

Competitive Landscape

	Street-vendor language	Zalo-native	Explains & files	Price fits hộ
MISA / KiotViet / Sapo	No	Partial	No	Partial
Tax agents (manual)	Yes	Partial	Yes	No
Excel / notebook	Yes	No	No	Yes
Sổ Sạch	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

We don't compete with tax agents — we arm them. The reseller tier turns the incumbent trust channel into our distribution.

07

Go-to-Market

- Phase 1 (0–3 mo): 100-household pilot in 2 HCMC districts via 3–5 tax-agent partners; 200 QR flyers per market street; Zalo OA live.
- Phase 2 (3–9 mo): quarterly-deadline campaigns (the product sells itself each filing season); agent dashboard; Zalo Mini App (zero-install, inside Zalo's 78M-user surface); e-invoice partner API.
- Phase 3 (9–18 mo): southern provinces via agent network; MoMo/ZaloPay bundles; 'verified compliant vendor' public profile as the marketing hook.

- Built-in viral loop: every declaration, receipt confirmation and monthly summary a household shares on Zalo carries the Sổ Sạch mark — each customer markets to their suppliers and customers. Two segments, one product: street retail (segment B) needs the ledger; online sellers (segment A, platform tax withheld at source) need the reconciliation and the refund paperwork.

08

Financial Projections

	Y1 (2027)	Y2 (2028)	Y3 (2029)
Subscribers	2,000	12,000	40,000
ARR	\$70k	\$450k	\$1.6M
Gross margin	85%	87%	88%
EBITDA	-\$90k	+\$60k	+\$520k

Assumptions: blended ARPU ~\$3.3/mo incl. Pro and agent tiers; churn 3.5%/mo year-1 falling to 2% (deadline seasonality drives re-activation); CAC <\$4 via agents and flyers. Illustrative, not a guarantee.

09

The Ask & The Exit

Use of funds (\$300k, 18 mo)	Amount	%
Product & AI ops (Zalo mini-app, agent dashboard, e-invoice API)	\$120k	40%
Agent network & field GTM	\$100k	33%
Compliance/legal (tax counsel, data residency)	\$40k	13%
Buffer	\$40k	13%

- Strategic buyers: MISA, Citigo/KiotViet, Sapo (distribution into the segment they miss), MoMo/ZaloPay (SME services push), VNG/Zalo itself. SME-SaaS comparables 4–6× ARR → \$6–10M outcome at Y3 scale.
- The data asset sharpens the exit: a verified, longitudinal transaction ledger on tens of thousands of micro-merchants is exactly the underwriting layer MoMo/VNPay/banks lack for merchant cash advances and working-capital lending — strategic value beyond the subscription revenue.
- Kill criteria (honest): if pilot week-4 retention <25% or agents won't resell at 30%, the wedge is wrong — pivot to agent-only tooling.

Contact

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Tax rates/thresholds encoded from cited regulations; to be validated with a licensed tax agent before commercial launch.